JAMES MITCHELL

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with six years of hands-on experience building and maintaining backend infrastructure that handles millions of requests daily. I've led teams through complex migrations, mentored junior developers into strong engineers, and consistently shipped features that improved system reliability and performance. I'm most energized when solving thorny architectural problems and helping other engineers grow in their roles.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

Vertex Systems

vertexsystems.io

Cambridge, United Kingdom

March 2023 - Present

Designed and implemented a new event streaming architecture that reduced message processing latency by 65%, handling 2 million events per day across our platform.

Led a team of four engineers through the migration of our monolithic payment service to microservices, completing the transition six weeks ahead of schedule with zero transaction loss.

Established engineering standards and code review practices that reduced production incidents by 48% over eight months.

Mentored three junior engineers to mid-level positions, with two promoted internally within the past year.

Senior Backend Engineer

CloudBridge Solutions

cloudbridge.co.uk

Cambridge, United Kingdom

July 2021 - February 2023

Architected and deployed a real-time data synchronization system serving 50+ enterprise clients, improving data freshness from 30 minutes to under 5 seconds.

Optimized database query performance across ten critical services, reducing average response times from 800ms to 150ms and cutting infrastructure costs by 22%.

Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting using Prometheus and Grafana, enabling the team to detect and resolve issues before customer impact.

Conducted weekly technical training sessions for the engineering team, covering distributed systems concepts and production debugging techniques.

Backend Engineer

NuData Technologies

nudata.net

Cambridge, United Kingdom

September 2019 - June 2021

Built and maintained authentication and authorization services handling 15 million daily active users with 99.99% uptime.

Refactored legacy codebase in Python, improving test coverage from 32% to 87% and eliminating a backlog of production bugs.

Collaborated with the DevOps team to containerize services and migrate from virtual machines to Kubernetes, reducing deployment time from two hours to eight minutes.

Responded to and resolved multiple critical incidents, implementing post-incident reviews that prevented recurrence.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Cambridge

Cambridge, United Kingdom

2015 - 2019

SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, Java, SQL, TypeScript

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Cassandra

Platforms and Tools: Kubernetes, Docker, AWS, Apache Kafka, Prometheus, Grafana

Specializations: Microservices Architecture, Distributed Systems, Database Optimization, Real-Time Data Processing

Other: System Design, Technical Leadership, Code Review, CI/CD Pipelines, Incident Management